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WW2 – M3U2 Midterms Assignment 8

1. Imagine you're setting up a new computer. How have modern mice and keyboards changed in their connection methods, and what are the main advantages over older technologies like PS/2 ports?

Modern mice and keyboards commonly use USB or Bluetooth, while older devices used PS/2. USB is easier to use because it supports plug and play, while Bluetooth allows the devices to work wirelessly without a cable.

2. You're using two USB external hard drives connected to your computer to back up large video files at the same time. Why might the transfer speed slow down significantly when both drives are active?

The transfer speed can slow down because both external drives are sharing the available USB bandwidth. When both drives are transferring large files at the same time, they have to share the connection's data capacity. USB versions have different maximum speeds, so the actual speed also depends on the USB version being used.

3. You're buying a new monitor for a computer and want the best picture quality for watching movies and playing games. What type of cable would you look for, and why is it preferred over older connections like VGA?

I would look for an HDMI cable because HDMI is a digital connection that supports high resolutions and high refresh rates. HDMI 2.1 can support up to 8K at 60Hz and 4K at 120Hz. VGA is an older analog connection, so HDMI is more suitable for modern displays and gaming.

4. You're shopping for a new widescreen monitor. What's the difference between a 1400x1050 and a 1920x1200 resolution, and which one is the better choice for watching a movie without black bars?

The 1920x1200 resolution has more pixels and has a wider screen shape than 1400x1050. I would choose 1920x1200 for watching movies because it is more suitable for widescreen content. However, depending on the movie's aspect ratio, some black bars may still appear.

5. You just bought a new ergonomic mouse and keyboard. What is the first place you would go on your computer to customize their settings, such as button functions or keyboard shortcuts?

I would first go to the Settings app. The lesson explains that mice and keyboards can be configured using the Settings app, while some mice may also need a vendor driver for additional custom settings.

6. A friend in another country is using your computer, and when they type the @ symbol, a different character appears. What is the most likely cause of this problem?

The most likely cause is that the keyboard layout or region setting is different. Different keyboard layouts can place symbols like @ in different locations, so the computer may be using another regional keyboard setting. The lesson notes that keyboard configuration includes layout and region.

7. For someone who plays competitive video games, what type of mouse would you recommend, and what is the key feature that makes it better for gaming?

I would recommend a gaming mouse, especially an optical or laser mouse with extra buttons. The key features are accurate movement and quick response, while extra buttons can make it easier to perform commands during games. The lesson identifies optical and laser mouse designs and optional extra buttons.